

Time Schedule.



outline

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- **Scheduling systems.**
- **Types of time scheduling.**
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- **Pros and cons of working a nurse's schedule.**

Definition of Scheduling

- **Is the planning pattern of on duty hours for employees in a particular unit for a given period. It is a timetable that shows planned workdays and shift for nursing personnel.**

Definition of Time scheduling

- **Time scheduling** is essential for effective time management, as it helps individuals or organizations make the most efficient use of their available time.
- **Time scheduling** refers to a specific plan or timetable and organizing activities or tasks within a specific timeframe.

**Importance of
time scheduling:**

- 1. Optimal patient care**
- 2. Workload balance**
- 3. Regulatory compliance**
- 4. Staffing efficiency**
- 5. Flexibility and adaptability**
- 6. Employee satisfaction and retention**
- 7. Collaboration and communication**



Principles of Scheduling

- **Shift Needs:** Schedule planning should meet the needs of each shift.
- **Balance:** Schedules must balance the needs of patients and nursing personnel.
- **Organizational Goals:** Use organizational goals and patient classification tools to minimize understaffing and overstaffing.
- **Minimal Changes:** Keep changes to the schedule minimal.
- **Duty Assurance:** Ensure nurses' assigned shifts are stable unless emergencies arise.



Cont.

- **Adequate Rest:** Avoid accumulation of days off to ensure adequate rest for staff.
- **Shift Overlap:** Provide overlap time between shifts for handovers.
- **Reporting Days:** Ensure head nurses have a day apart from their replacements for adequate reporting.
- **Night Shift Recovery:** Give a day off after night shifts.
- **Fairness:** Promote fairness and equity in rostering.
- **Rest Periods:** Ensure sufficient rest periods and breaks between shifts.

Scheduling systems:

1- Centralized Scheduling:

Decision making occurs in a “centralized” location for the entire institution.

2- Decentralized Scheduling:

Decision making occurs with the nurse manager on the unit. When managers are given authority and assume responsibility, they can staff their own units through decentralized scheduling.

Scheduling systems:

3- Mixed Scheduling:

An individual may manage staffing but with the option of consulting a centralized office to help fill open shifts. Blends aspects of items 1 and 2. Individual units may manage staffing, but if they cannot fill open shifts, they might forward their needs to a centralized office.

4- Computerized scheduling

Computerized scheduling in nursing, also known as automated or electronic scheduling, is a type of automated program that plans nursing shifts. Nursing managers can use this scheduling software to ensure the schedule is fair to nurses and meets all clinical needs.

Types of time scheduling:

- **1- Block Scheduling:**
- Block scheduling involves assigning nurses to work consecutive shifts within a defined period, such as several days or weeks. Here are some key **characteristics** of block scheduling:
- **Consistent Shifts:** Nurses are assigned to a specific block of shifts, typically consisting of multiple consecutive days or weeks.
- **Predictability:** Block scheduling provides nurses with a predictable schedule, as they know in advance when they will be working and when they will have time off.

cont. **Types of time scheduling:**

2- Cyclic Scheduling:

- **Cyclic scheduling involves rotating nurses through different shifts and work patterns over a predetermined cycle. Nurses are assigned to different shifts or work patterns following a predetermined cycle. This can include rotating through morning, evening, and night shifts, as well as different days of the week.**

cont. **Types of time scheduling:**

3- Self-Scheduling:

- **In this type of scheduling system, the scheduling is coordinated by staff nurses. It saves the manager considerable scheduling time. This system also increases staff members' ability to negotiate with each other. Individual staff members schedule themselves. The nurse manager then works with staff members to fill empty slots. Nurses choose their shifts for the month within certain guidelines. They collaborate to ensure all shifts are covered. This method provides flexibility and often improves job satisfaction.**

cont. Types of time scheduling:

4- On-Call Scheduling:

- **Nurses are scheduled to be available to work if needed but are not actively working unless called in. This type of scheduling is common for handling emergencies or unexpected staff shortages.**

cont. Types of time scheduling:

5- Pro Re Nata “PRN” shifts:

- PRN stands for *Pro Re Nata* – Latin for “as the **circumstance arises**”. This means nurses work as and when they are needed and don’t have a fixed schedule.
- It’s commonly used by hospitals or healthcare groups with multiple locations as nurses on a PRN schedule can be called in by any of the locations to address staffing shortages or short-term capacity challenges.
- It gives nurses who can’t work a full-time role more flexibility, gives nursing director during shortages. But it's unpredictable for nurses because they’re never certain of when they’ll be working, hard to plan ahead, and may reach out to someone and discover they’re unavailable at the requested time.

Difference between On-Call Scheduling and PRN Shifts:

Key Differences	On-Call Nurses	PRN Nurses
Commitment	Scheduled obligation to be available during specific times.	Work only when they agree to take a shift.
Availability	Ready to respond during designated times.	Flexible, work based on their availability.
Compensation Structure	Might receive standby pay plus regular pay when called in.	Typically paid a higher hourly rate but only for the hours worked.

